

Module 1: Orientation & Quick Start – Knowledge Check

This quiz is designed to verify that you have mastered the 40% of new skills required to turn your existing background into a high-velocity income stream. In this industry, "almost right" is a rejection. Let's ensure you hit 100%.

Multiple Choice (8 Questions)

1. What is the primary purpose of a Property Condition Report (PCR) in the mortgage field services industry? A. To provide a diagnostic evaluation of structural systems for a homebuyer. B. To document observable facts about an asset's condition for a lender. C. To estimate the cost of necessary repairs to increase property value. D. To verify that a property meets all local building and safety codes.

- **Correct: B.** A field inspector is a specialized documentarian providing empirical data for lenders to manage risk.
- **Incorrect A:** This describes a home inspection for a consumer.
- **Incorrect C:** Field inspectors never provide repair estimates; they only document what is seen.
- **Incorrect D:** Code compliance is the job of a government building inspector, not a mortgage field inspector.

2. As an independent contractor in this field, how is your income typically structured? A. An hourly wage with a guaranteed minimum of 40 hours per week. B. A per-inspection fee with no taxes or Medicare deducted from your pay. C. A commission based on the final sale price of the foreclosed property. D. A flat monthly salary provided by a single regional firm.

- **Correct: B.** You are self-employed and paid on a per-job basis, allowing you to scale income by increasing efficiency.
- **Incorrect A:** Field work is volume-based, not a traditional hourly employee role.
- **Incorrect C:** Income is not tied to property value or sales; it is tied to the completion of the report.
- **Incorrect D:** Independent contractors often work for multiple clients to maximize volume and income.

3. Which of the following is a mandatory component of the "6-Angle Rule" for exterior inspections? A. A photo of the inspector standing in front of the property to prove presence. B. A photo of the nearest street sign to verify the location within the neighborhood. C. An interior shot of the furnace and water heater. D. A photo taken through the windshield to show the approach to the house.

- **Correct: B.** The street sign proves the inspector is in the correct location and neighborhood.

- **Incorrect A:** Inspectors must never be visible in their own photos.
- **Incorrect C:** While required for interior inspections, this is not part of the standard 6-Angle exterior rule.
- **Incorrect D:** Photos must never be taken through a car window or windshield.

4. What does the term SLA (Service Level Agreement) refer to in your work order? A. The amount of insurance coverage the inspector must carry. B. The specific code used to enter a lockbox. C. The contractual deadline for the completion and submission of your report. D. The legal agreement between the homeowner and the mortgage lender.

- **Correct: C.** SLAs are the deadlines (typically 3–7 days) that govern the delivery of an inspection.
- **Incorrect A:** While insurance is required, it is not what "SLA" stands for.
- **Incorrect B:** Lockbox codes are usually found in the "Info/Comments" tab.
- **Incorrect D:** The SLA is the agreement between the inspector/vendor and the client regarding performance.

5. Which tool is essential for checking the presence of electricity at a vacant property without touching potentially live wires? A. A digital multimeter. B. A non-contact volt stick (voltage tester). C. A standard HUD key set. D. A thermal imaging camera.

- **Correct: B.** A \$10 volt stick allows you to safely check for active power at an exterior outlet.
- **Incorrect A:** Multimeters require contact with wires, which is invasive and outside your scope.
- **Incorrect C:** HUD keys are for access, not for testing utilities.
- **Incorrect D:** Thermal cameras are advanced diagnostic tools used by home inspectors, not required for basic field work.

6. If you encounter a dog while on a property, what is the recommended safety protocol? A. Run back to your vehicle as quickly as possible to trigger the dog's retreat. B. Make direct eye contact to establish dominance over the animal. C. Stand still and remain calm with the side of your body facing the dog. D. Shout loudly to alert the neighbors and scare the dog away.

- **Correct: C.** Remaining still and avoiding direct eye contact prevents triggering the dog's prey instinct.
- **Incorrect A:** Running triggers a "prey instinct," making a chase and bite more likely.
- **Incorrect B:** Direct eye contact can be perceived as a challenge or threat by an aggressive dog.
- **Incorrect D:** Loud noises and panic can escalate a dog's aggression.

7. Which of these is considered a "Primary Indicator" that a property is occupied? A. The lawn is freshly mowed and manicured. B. An electric meter with a spinning dial or digital readout. C. Personal property like a grill or patio furniture is visible. D. The occupant answers the door and confirms residency.

- **Correct: D.** Direct confirmation from an occupant is the highest level of occupancy evidence.
- **Incorrect A:** This is a "Secondary Indicator" as it could be maintained by a preservation company.
- **Incorrect B:** A spinning meter is a strong technical cue, but direct confirmation or "signs of life" are preferred.
- **Incorrect C:** Furniture indicates property, but "Furniture does not occupy property. People occupy property".

8. What is the standard technical requirement for all inspection photos? A. High-resolution Portrait mode to capture tall buildings. B. Landscape mode (horizontal) to fit standard lender viewing portals. C. Black and white filters to highlight structural cracks. D. Zoomed-in shots only to save on file size.

- **Correct: B.** Landscape mode is the industry standard; portrait shots are frequently rejected.
- **Incorrect A:** Portrait mode is specifically cited as a common reason for report rejection.
- **Incorrect C:** Photos must be clear and represent actual conditions, requiring standard color.
- **Incorrect D:** The "Front Elevation" shot must show the entire roofline with space on all sides for context.

True/False (3 Questions)

9. True or False: Because you represent the lender, you are authorized to discuss the borrower's late payments or foreclosure status during a door knock.

- **Answer: False.** Discussing delinquency is a violation of the Fair Debt Collection Practices Act (FDCPA). You are a documentarian, not a debt collector.
- **Explanation:** Using "trigger words" like *arrears* or *foreclosure* can lead to severe legal penalties for you and the firm.

10. True or False: As an independent contractor, you are responsible for your own online security, vehicle maintenance, and fuel costs.

- **Answer: True.** You operate as a "mobile office" and must maintain your own equipment, though these are often tax-deductible.
- **Explanation:** You are a sole proprietor entitled to tax write-offs for mileage, phone bills, and home office space.

11. True or False: A photo containing a portion of your car's dashboard or side-mirror is acceptable as long as the house is clearly visible.

- **Answer: False.** The presence of car parts indicates a "drive-by" inspection, which violates contracts requiring a full visual survey.
 - **Explanation:** Reports with "car parts" are rejected immediately because they fail to prove you exited the vehicle.
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Scenario-Based (4 Questions)

12. [REALTOR TRANSITION] You are inspecting a home with a visible crack in the foundation. The homeowner asks you, "Is my house safe to live in?" How do you respond in your report? A. "Property is in poor condition; foundation is failing and unsafe for occupancy." B. "A horizontal crack is visible on the west foundation wall." C. "Foundation requires immediate repair by a licensed contractor." D. "I told the homeowner the house appears stable but needs a professional check."

- **Correct: B.** This is objective documentation of an observable fact.
- **Incorrect A:** This is a diagnostic conclusion, which is outside your scope and a liability risk.
- **Incorrect C:** You are prohibited from recommending repairs or contractors.
- **Incorrect D:** You should never provide verbal assessments to homeowners; it exceeds your expertise.

13. [NOTARY TRANSITION] You arrive at a property where the utilities are off, the grass is long, and no one answers the door. However, there is a brand-new package on the porch and the doorbell is lit. What is your occupancy determination? A. Vacant, because the utilities are disconnected and the yard is neglected. B. Unknown, because you did not speak to a person. C. Occupied, based on "signs of life" like the new delivery and lit doorbell. D. Vacant, but with personal property remaining.

- **Correct: C.** A lit doorbell and new deliveries are strong indicators of active residency, even if maintenance is deferred.
- **Incorrect A:** Utilities and yard condition are secondary; "signs of life" take precedence.
- **Incorrect B:** Reporting "Unknown" is useless to the lender (like "a hamburger without the meat").
- **Incorrect D:** If someone is collecting mail/packages, the property is not vacant.

14. [GIG WORKER TRANSITION] You have 10 "Rush" inspections due by 5 PM. To save time, you decide to take the "Side of House" photos from the sidewalk rather than walking to the rear. Is this acceptable? A. Yes, as long as you can see the side of the house clearly. B. No, because you must conduct a full visual walk-around to check for "waste" or hazards like unsecured pools. C. Yes, if the grass is too tall to walk through safely. D. No, because you must always use a monopod for side shots.

- **Correct: B.** You are the "eyes and ears" for the lender; skipping the walk-around might miss critical liabilities like an open back door or a hole in the roof.

- **Incorrect A:** Most contracts require you to exit the vehicle and survey the entire property.
- **Incorrect C:** While safety is a priority, you must still document that you attempted the full survey or report the area as inaccessible.
- **Incorrect D:** Monopods are typically only required for specific roof photos, not standard side views.

15. You are performing an interior inspection of a vacant home. You notice a TV and a laptop on a table. What is the correct protocol? A. Remove the items for safekeeping and notify your account manager. B. Take photos of the items and estimate their "Garage Sale Value" if over \$100. C. Move the items to a more secure location inside the house, such as a closet. D. Ignore the items as they are not "real estate" and don't affect the lender.

- **Correct: B.** Personal property items with significant value must be documented to help the lender assess the "trash out" or preservation needs.
- **Incorrect A:** Removing anything from a property is grounds for immediate dismissal and potential criminal charges.
- **Incorrect C:** You must never move personal property; you are there only to document its presence.
- **Incorrect D:** Lenders need to know if personal property remains to determine if the property is truly "abandoned" vs. just "vacant".